

INTERNSHIP FINAL REPORT

Higher Professional Technical Course

Digital Marketing

Internship Report

Optimization and Automation of Digital Marketing Processes: Implementation of a
MarkOps Ecosystem and Artificial Intelligence Integration in the Marketing Hub

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Summary

This report details the activities developed and the competencies acquired during the curricular internship of the Higher Professional Technical Course (CTeSP) in Digital Marketing, carried out at the University's Marketing Unit Lusophone. The internship, which began in February 2026, had as its central focus the practical application of theoretical knowledge obtained throughout the study cycle, integrating the intern into a real and dynamic professional environment where execution strategy and the optimization of digital assets were priorities.

During the intervention period, the central tasks were divided into areas fundamental aspects of performance marketing and direct communication. One significant component of the work involved the analysis and management of databases of keywords, focusing on cleaning, organizing and monitoring rankings to improve organic visibility. At the same time, there was active involvement in the creation, configuration and management of paid advertising campaigns in several advertising platforms, aiming to promote training offers for markets national and international. The communication aspect was complemented with the development of email marketing flows, from content design to finalizing graphic assets necessary for its implementation.

The work methodology adopted privileged the continuous optimization of processes and the rigorous organization of files and campaigns. The technical approach allowed not only the execution of operational tasks, but also participation in moments of training and updating on best practices for monitoring conversions and market trends. Critical analysis of the tools used allowed identifying opportunities for improvement in the internal organization of data and the effectiveness of the entity's digital communication.

In conclusion, the experience allowed a profound consolidation of traffic management skills, technical SEO and communication strategy email. The results obtained through the implementation of the described tasks

demonstrate the importance of articulation between academic theory and practice professional, validating the intern's ability to respond to the challenges of a modern marketing department. The internship fulfilled the pedagogical objectives proposed, contributing decisively to the professional and technical profile in the area of Digital Marketing.

Keywords: Digital Marketing, Campaign Management, Process Optimization, SEO, Digital Strategy.

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Part I

1. Introduction

This internship was designed with the central focus on managing traffic campaigns paid (Paid Media), integrating, according to the initial plan, a component comprehensive support in web development, email marketing and communications organization for the educational group (Universidade Lusófona, IPLUSO, ISMAT, ISLA-IPGT, ISLA Santarém and ISDOM). My initial objective was clear: accept all challenges proposed and maximize learning about all of the operations of the department. However, in the first few weeks, immersion in operational reality revealed a systemic bottleneck: the manual management of a portfolio of more than 300 courses, combined with the multiplicity of support tasks, made execution unsustainable conventional.

The need that motivated the intervention was administrative inefficiency in the face of load peaks. When mass launching campaigns, the manual process of insertion of headlines and descriptions became a critical bottleneck, requiring dozens of hours of continuous and exhaustive team effort. This model of work, in addition to being unsustainable, opened room for human errors and prevented team to focus on strategic analysis.

Recognizing that most of these tasks required repetitive execution and exhaustive, I decided to pivot my approach: automate all tasks with AI of low cognitive value. My intervention evolved from an operative execution for building a Marketing Operations (MarkOps) infrastructure. O

The objective became the creation of an automation system that supported the management of these multiple fronts, ensuring the technical integrity of the ecosystem, through proactive link monitoring, data hygiene and security scripts validation, freeing up resources for strategic thinking.

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This report is structured into two fundamental parts. Part I is dedicated to the theoretical foundation, exploring the evolution towards Marketing 5.0 and the critical importance of automation in digital data management. Part II details the practical component: the characterization of the entity, the intervention plan executed (focused on the automation of transversal processes), the discussion of results obtained, proving the drastic reduction in operational time, and, therefore, Finally, the critical analysis of the processes found and the proposal of future solutions.

1.1 Internship Objectives

The established work plan aimed to achieve objectives multidimensional:

- Practical Application: Translate the concepts of traffic management, SEO and email marketing for real campaigns targeting national and international.

- Process Optimization: Develop organizational and data cleansing to maximize the efficiency of data collection tools monitoring and conversion.

- Innovation and Operational Efficiency: Investigate and integrate Artificial Intelligence (AI Agents) in department workflows. O

The central objective was to use these tools to accelerate drastically the processes of market research, data analysis and subsequent technical implementation of campaigns, reducing friction and execution time between strategic planning and digital operations.

- Professional Development: Consolidate management skills time, resilience and adaptation to team dynamics and workflows institutions, simultaneously deepening critical thinking and analytical. The aim was to learn how to leverage all the resources available strategically, maximizing efficiency and value

operational contribution in order to make my intervention as useful and as impactful as possible for the department.

1.2 Report Structure

For a clear presentation of the activities carried out, the report is organized into two fundamental parts:

●■ Part I – Theoretical Framework: Where concepts are explored fundamental aspects of digital marketing and the theories that support decisions taken during internship.

●■ Part II – Practical Component and Results: Where the characterization of the host entity, the intervention plan carried out (including the management of campaigns and technological projects) and the respective critical analysis of the results obtained.

Through this structure, we intend to demonstrate that digital marketing, when executed with technical rigor and openness to innovation, it is a vital tool for growth and sustainability of any institution in the digital ecosystem contemporary.

Project Objectives

Defining objectives demonstrates the purpose of the work performed and how this aligns with the skills acquired during training. This section is divided on two levels: the general objective and the specific objectives.

1. General Objective

Apply and consolidate the theoretical and operational knowledge acquired in the Course Higher Professional Technician (CTeSP) in Digital Marketing in a context highly demanding professional. The central focus of this intervention lies in contributing actively for the tactical execution and strategic optimization of the company's operations Marketing Unit of Universidade Lusófona, assuming a role focused on

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problem solving, maximizing department efficiency and deepening critical thinking in the face of real challenges.

2. Specific Objectives

To achieve the general objective, the intervention plan was fragmented into goals concrete operational:

Digital Management and Strategy

- Perform intensive keyword research and structure marketing campaigns

paid advertising, ensuring that the user's search intent is strictly aligns with institutional fundraising objectives.

- Build and optimize conversion forms, focusing on eliminating friction points in the user journey to maximize revenue capture leads.

- Structure and operate the email marketing aspect, establishing flows independent of direct communication for the nutrition and retention of contacts.

- Manage and update the content of the institutional website relating to international partnership programs, ensuring accuracy and alignment of communication for external markets.

Optimization and Analysis (SEO and Analytics)

- Continuously monitor the performance and positioning of keywords (applied tactically to both the Ads ecosystem and the organic traffic/SEO), supporting agile adjustments to the bidding strategy and content production.

- Develop and host analytical dashboards on GitHub Pages, based on a direct integrations infrastructure (Google Ads API, Google Search Console and Google Sheets). This ecosystem includes native API integration of Gemini directly on the dashboard, allowing advanced analysis and automated data analysis in real time, supported by Artificial Intelligence.

Innovation and Operational Efficiency

- Integrate AI Agents into the department's daily workflows, delegating iterative research and technical execution processes to accelerate drastically reduce operating speed and free up resources for strategic component.
- Perform technical and structural cleaning of databases (Sheets cleanup), eliminating redundancies to ensure that the information used in monitoring and campaigns maintains maximum integrity and analytical feasibility.

Theoretical Framework

The theoretical foundation of this report is based on the evolution of paradigms of digital communication, exploring the concepts that support communication methodologies capture, conversion and automation applied during the internship.

1. The Evolution of Marketing: From Institutional to Marketing 5.0

The Higher Education ecosystem has historically operated under a logic of institutional and passive reputation marketing, strongly anchored in tactics Top of Funnel (TOFU) generalists. However, the consumer journey Contemporary demands a more sophisticated approach. According to Kotler, Kartajaya and Setiawan (2021), the transition to "Marketing 5.0" dictates the application of technologies that mimic human behavior to create, communicate and deliver value.

Today, the enrollment decision of a potential student is not dictated solely by static prestige of the institution, but due to the technical capacity of the brand in intercept your search intent in an agile and personalized way (Kotler et al., 2021). This evolution underlies the urgency of transitioning from a reactive operation for a data-driven infrastructure.

2. Performance Marketing and SEO: Visibility and Conversion

In the field of Digital Marketing, effectiveness is measured by the ability to generate tangible results through the strategic management of digital channels. Chaffey and Ellis-Chadwick (2019) emphasize that the success of the online presence depends on the optimizing the intersection between user intent and brand offering, transforming the digital ecosystem into a surgical conversion engine. No context of search engines, this approach requires an exhaustive search of keywords and continuous monitoring, applied both to paid advertising (Search Engine Marketing - SEM) and organic traffic (Search

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Engine Optimization - SEO). Ryan (2016) reinforces that the alignment between the investment in ads and organic authority guarantees that the institution does not acquire only volume of traffic, but qualified relevance, maximizing the Return on Investment (ROI).

3. Data Analytics and Integration: From Noise to Actionable Decision

In the context of digital analytics, the true usefulness of data does not lie in its mere accumulation, but in the ability to extract actionable insights. Kaushik (2010) argues that organizations must move away from obsessing over performance metrics vanity and focusing on data that drives business decisions. This premise theory supports the development of integrated analytical infrastructures (crossing tools such as Google Ads and Google Search Console). When processing these metrics centrally, technical SEO and campaign management cease to be empirical tasks and become strictly driven by real performance data, allowing route corrections in time useful.

4. Direct Communication and Loyalty: Permission Marketing

Lead capture and subsequent email communication should move away from intrusive logic. The concept of "Permission Marketing", coined by Godin (1999), is based on the privilege of sending advance messages, personal and relevant to individuals who have expressed a voluntary desire for the receive. This theory underlies the need to design forms of optimized capture that reduces friction in the user journey and allows primary segmentation. By applying segmentation right at the moment of conversion, institution ensures that direct communication via email marketing is highly relevant, which, according to Chaffey and Ellis-Chadwick (2019), increases significantly increase open rates and conversion likelihood over the course of digital funnel.

5. Artificial Intelligence in Operational Marketing

The most recent revolution in operational marketing concerns the adoption of Artificial Intelligence (AI). The integration of AI agents and language models large scale (LLMs) enable the automation of repetitive, low-value tasks cognitive. Davenport, Guha, Grewal and Bressgott (2020) highlight that AI in marketing frees professionals to think strategically, assuming optimization processes and continuous technical surveillance. More than a tool support, AI acts as a critical accelerator of the operations lifecycle, reducing the gap between strategic design and tactical execution of campaigns.

Part II

2. Company Characterization

2.1. The Lusófona University Marketing Hub

The Lusófona University Marketing Unit operates as a Strategic Hub of shared services for the educational group. Unlike a department of traditional marketing, this unit functions as a centralized agency that holds strategic and executive responsibility for multiple brands, with residual autonomy on the part of individual institutions.

2.2. Portfolio and Scale of Operation

The workflow encompasses the simultaneous management of a vast ecosystem:

- National Institutions: Universidade Lusófona (Lisbon and Porto), IPLUSO, ISMAT, ISLA-IPGT, ISLA Santarém and ISDOM.
- International Projects and Consortiums: Management of the digital presence of elite programs such as FilmEU, DocNomads, SPARC and Pathfinder.
- Foreign Operations: Centralized management of Google Ads campaigns for campuses in Guinea-Bissau, Cape Verde, Angola and Brazil.

2.3. Pillars of the Department's Operations

The department's standard operation is based on the convergence between the Traditional Marketing (offline) and a strong digital component divided between Management Traffic, Web Development, Social Media and Automation. It's on this basis that the internship intervention plan was designed, focusing on increasing technology of these pillars.

3. Intervention Plan and Activities Developed

The intervention plan reflects the transition from academic knowledge to practice in a large-scale marketing environment.

Figure 3.0 – Main interface of the "Marketing Hub": Centralized dashboard command with secure authentication and language model (AI) integration.

Figure 3.0 illustrates the work environment developed for the Marketing. This ecosystem brings together all the tools for MarkOps created during the internship. To ensure data integrity and institutional compliance, access to the Hub is protected by a layer of strict authentication, ensuring that only authorized users access the

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automation infrastructure. This interface serves as the Single Source of Truth team operational.

3.1. Operational Context

The Lusófona University Marketing Unit acts as a centralized Hub of shared services for the educational group. The marketing autonomy of individual institutions is residual, falling on this department to responsibility for executing almost the entire digital strategy of brands with different audiences and geographies. The daily workflow encompasses management simultaneous access to a vast portfolio: Universidade Lusófona, IPLUSO, ISMAT, ISLA-IPGT, ISDOM and ISLA Santarém. Additionally, the department manages the digital presence of international projects (e.g. FilmEU, DocNomads, SPARC and Pathfinder) and paid campus traffic campaign operations international projects in Guinea-Bissau, Cape Verde, Angola and Brazil. This centralization requires technical agility superior to that of a conventional agency.

3.2. Technological Ecosystem (MarkOps Stack)

- Automation and CRM: Zoho Campaigns and Zoho Forms.
- MarkOps and Data: Google Sheets, Google Apps Script, GitHub and PowerShell.
- Artificial Intelligence: Google AI Studio, Google Antigravity, Gemini model, LMStudio.
- UI/UX and Design: Adobe Illustrator, Affinity and Phosphor Icons library.

3.3. Execution (Project Phases)

Phase 1: Diagnosis and Hygiene (Ads & Keywords)

Development of the functional Ads Launcher prototype and infrastructure automated validation in Google Sheets via Google Apps Script (with support from Gemini), which triggers visual flags in case of structural error and which also allows,

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much faster than natively available, organize and extract data.

Figure 3.1 – Marketing Toolkit customization interface developed via Google Apps Script in the Google Sheets ecosystem, triggering dynamic menus for campaign automation and data hygiene.

As illustrated in Figure 3.1, technical intervention was not limited to the execution of abstract code in the background; resulted in the creation of a native menu personalized called Marketing Toolkit. This democratization interface data allowed complex automation commands such as injection automated market data (Inject Market Data) or quick corrections of interface (Heal UI), were executed directly by operators through the dynamic menu, mitigating logical errors and eliminating the need for intervention directly into the source code by the operational marketing team.

Phase 2: Scale and Standardization in Email Marketing

Development of standardized templates and implementation of a block style editor in Zoho Campaigns to shield the visual integrity of communication.

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Figure 3.2 – Dynamic content editor interface based on HTML blocks native built for scalable standardization and agile editing of workflows direct communication.

The editing system in dynamic block format (Figure 3.2) was built to shield the visual integrity of institutional communication in the six faculties of the group. By separating the rigid HTML code structure (where selectors operate Styling Tools and Automated Footers) of the Content Fill Layer of the block, it was ensured that non-technical execution teams could update campaigns dynamically without compromising layout or visual compliance established in the department.

Phase 3: Proactive Monitoring and MarkOps (URL Checker)

Building a headless intelligent agent via PowerShell for proactive tracking of 404 errors on active paid advertising landing pages every 30 minutes, protecting advertising budgets against losses arising from outages page.

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Figure 3.3 – Centralized monitoring console (Live Routing Switchboard) with real-time endpoint status display and automatic calculation of days inoperability (Days Down).

Figure 3.3 shows the centralized control panel (Live Routing Switchboard) designed as the visible face of the intelligent agent. Through light signaling status (green for operational, red for anomaly detected), the paid traffic operators and the technical team have a panoramic and immediate response to critical flaws in the ecosystem. The system quantifies dynamically the Days Down metric, parameterizing the time elapsed since the breach of technical integrity to facilitate performance audits.

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Figure 3.4 – Execution record (log) of the autonomous agent in a desktop environment terminal (PowerShell), highlighting the continuous tracking of landing HTTP status institutional pages.

The operational basis of this monitoring ecosystem is based on execution silent version of the script detailed in Figure 3.4. The automation routine runs through iteratively the database of active URLs in campaigns, validating the code server response (guaranteeing 200 OK status) and counting the waiting time inactivity. It is this workflow processing that feeds, in real time, the alerts and department visual dashboards.

The Marketing Operations (MarkOps) strategy adopted allowed the transition of a purely manual operating model for an ecosystem of systems resilient, scalable and automated.

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4. Discussion of Results

4.1. Operational Efficiency and Process Optimization

The implementation of validation systems via Google Apps Script allowed disruptive transition in Paid Media management. Reducing launch time of campaigns from an estimated 24 hours to 10 minutes (99.3% optimization) translates into a significant productivity gain that eliminates the waste of resources on manual and repetitive tasks. This automation mitigated the human error, allowing the team's efforts to be redirected towards analyzing performance.

Figure 4.1 – Integrated Keyword Explorer Board analytical panel for tracking continuous synergies of paid (Paid Ads) and organic (GSC) traffic and monitoring competitive positioning.

To materialize the strategic concept of 'Single Source of Truth', a the Keyword Explorer Board (Figure 4.1), which merges the information collected from the Google Search Console and Google Ads. This panel allows you to analyze in real time integrated organic and paid metrics, such as the evolution of search volume per institution and the simultaneous impact on paid advertising channels, through a

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indicator of synergy between channels (Cross-Channel Synergy). This centralization transformed semantic planning, previously “siloe”, into a process agile based on the real performance of brands.

4.2. From Research Intentionality to Strategic Readiness

The restructuring of the keyword pool focused on the grain size of the intention to candidate search:

- Model Transition: Moving from a traffic volume strategy

generic for high surgical intentionality.

- Semantic Segmentation: Creation of alternative ad groups for intercept candidates for the exact terms sought, increasing relevance of landing pages.

- Performance Legacy: The delivered infrastructure shields the paid advertising against wasted budget, creating the technical foundations necessary to increase the Quality Score and consequent cost reduction per click (CPC).

4.3. Proactive Monitoring and Ecosystem Health

The construction of the PowerShell agent represented a milestone in monitoring the health web. By replacing reactive error mapping with a check automated every 30 minutes, the risk of ad disapproval was mitigated and the wasted investment on inoperative URLs.

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Figure 4.2 – Automated structured notification ("Antigravity Alert") generated via PowerShell and distributed immediately to mitigate active 404 errors in paid traffic operations.

The materialization of the proactivity described in the tactical plan is supported by the issuance of automated visual alerts, such as the one detailed in Figure 4.2. The agent of PowerShell, when detecting an active 404 error on links associated with paid ads, dispatches a priority notification (Antigravity Alert) with mapping logic by institution and direct links for quick audit (Check). This approach drastically reduces the response time to anomalies, protecting the allocated budget against unnecessary operational losses.

5. Critical Analysis and Proposed Solutions

5.1. Critical Analysis: Identification of Bottlenecks

●■ "Siloization" and Briefing Degradation (Process Entropy): Observed a critical disconnect between raw content production (Directors of Course) and operational implementation (Marketing). The input flow is often inefficient, without technical specifications and subject to chains of extensive e-mails, which forces the operational team to act in a reactive and carry out SEO corrections afterwards.

●■ Ambiguity in Operational Planning and Priorities: Lack of transparency in the allocation of workloads and visibility of the cross-cutting backlog in tools like Asana generates a reactive environment focused on "putting out fires", limiting the strategic effectiveness of execution.

●■ "False Economy" and Technical Debt: The use of heterogeneous software and the lack of unified integration creates severe technical debt that penalizes daily collaboration (e.g. incompatibilities between Affinity and Illustrator). The cost in productivity of resolving these frictions is vastly higher than the value of unified professional licensing.

5.2. Solution Proposals and Strategic Roadmap

5.2.1. Content Normalization via AI (Hybrid Approach)

Implementation of a local AI model that acts as a “data layer” intelligent normalization, adjusting raw teacher inputs according to SEO guidelines and group writing before its web insertion.

Figure 4.3 – Responsive Search Ad (RSA) intelligent editing console with Gemini 3 model native integration into tactical editor and time preview real advertising mockups.

To respond to the challenge of speed of technical execution and standardization of institutional copywriting described in the bottlenecks, the prototyped solution incorporates natively use the Gemini API (Figure 4.3) directly in the administration panel of ads from Ads Launcher. This allows the operator to enter content raw course content and immediately receive suggestions for headlines and descriptions adapted to the candidates' search semantics, mirrored in the preview instant ad across mobile and desktop formats, reducing substantially the launch friction.

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5.2.2. Technical and Strategic Maturation Roadmap

- Ads Launcher Hardening: Transition of the developed prototype code in Phase 1 for a robust, API-integrated production tool announcement officers, completely eliminating manual variable management.
- Centralized SQL Architecture: Total migration of the keyword repository and copywriting data from Google Sheets files to a database Structured and scalable SQL, eliminating fragility and inconsistency of manual accesses.
- Automated Integration with GSC: Automation of collection processes Google Search Console data via API to gain insight continuous synergy between channels (Paid + Organic).
- "Mission Command" Framework in Asana: Decentralization of the mission matrix decision, ensuring full visibility of the backlog to all operational staff, measuring success by KPIs achieved (Management by Results) instead of bureaucratic approval processes.

Conclusions

Upon completing the 650 hours of internship at the University's Marketing Unit Lusófona, the fundamental conclusion is the validation of the robustness of the curricular plan of the CTeSP. Professional practice proved to be a faithful mirror of theory, differentiating itself from only on the scale and restrictions typical of a corporate environment. The transition from the classroom to the "trench" of a centralized department confirmed that the core of the operation is, effectively, the same; the difference lies in the capacity of dealing with the variables and limitations that the "real world" imposes. My evolution throughout this period transcended the mere execution of tasks. The internship acted as an accelerator of technical maturity and pragmatism operational. I leave this experience with a level of confidence in my abilities significantly superior technology, manifested even in the transition to more open and technical operating system environments, such as Linux, and in implementing local AI models as an integral part of my workflow diary. I leave with a keen awareness that organization and clarity in everyday life are the foundations of efficiency. Where before I saw only the need to "do", today I see the imperative of "automating and simplifying". The experience allowed me to filter out the noise and focus on what really generates value: efficiency in mundane tasks to free up time for strategy. Finally, this journey reinforced my philosophical conviction about the area: the Modern Digital Marketing is a discipline that flourishes through experience technique and empirical experimentation, far surpassing the static consultation of theoretical manuals. The maxim that marketing is a "show me, don't tell me" (show me, don't tell me) was confirmed daily. The effectiveness does not resides in the rhetoric about what should be done, but in the technical capacity to do it. execute, measure and optimize. I leave this stage not as a spectator of the strategy, but as an executor who deeply understands the mechanics that makes the gear turn.

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